Student Groups

Students at the San José State University School of Information are highly encouraged to participate in the student chapters of professional associations and special interest groups. It's a great way to meet peers, gain experience for resume building, and network.

Check out the student groups offered at the SJSU iSchool:

Advocacy Student Group

The Library Advocacy Student Group's vision is to provide engaging opportunities for students interested in library advocacy. We hope to create and sustain a community that values learning experiences, collaboration and networking, sharing of informational resources and mutual encouragement by facilitating educational opportunities and activities to influence decision-making at the local, regional, state, national, and international level that result in funding or policy changes in support of public, school, and special libraries. The Library Advocacy Group believes that libraries are an essential public good that are fundamental to democratic societies. The Library Advocacy Group believes that libraries are an essential public good and are fundamental to democratic societies. We uphold the principles of intellectual freedom, resist censorship, and strive to empower voices who have been excluded from positions of power and the historical record with a focus on human rights and dignity.

- SJSU Library Advocacy site
- Instagram
- X Feed

American Library Association Student Chapter (ALASC)

The American Library Association Student Chapter (ALASC) at SJSU was founded on May 17, 1994, and is the 42nd official student chapter of the ALA. The purpose of ALASC is to foster participation in the ALA and use of its publications, scholarships and conferences; to encourage scholarly achievement and professional awareness of issues in library and information science; to provide a local forum for the exchange of information about trends, issues, and opportunities; to provide a supportive environment in which members can share their creativity, teach their skills, offer their experience, their expertise, and learn from each other.

- ALASC Website
- ALASC Instagram

Association for Information Science & Technology Student chapter (ASIS&T SC)

The Association for Information Science & Technology Student Chapter (ASIS&T SC) supports professional growth & career development of student members by providing educational programming, networking & other enriching opportunities. We strive to uphold the values of the ASIS&T professional organization including promoting research, sharing interdisciplinary knowledge, open access, & EDI by creating a community of iSchool students that explore, learn and apply principles of information science and technology that empowers the future of information workers across the globe.

- ASIS&T SC Website
- ASIS&T Website

Asian American, Native Hawaiian and Pacific Islander (AANHPI) iSchool Student Group

The AANHPI iSchool Student Group is focused on bringing awareness to the needs of AANHPI students and staff in information professions, engaging the student body in recognition and support for AANHPI students and communities, and promoting connection and cultural understanding. We invite any students interested in supporting the AANHPI community to join. All are welcome!

- AANHPI iSchool Student Group Website

Black Student Library Collective (BSLC)

The Mission of the BSLC at San José State is to champion the creation and advancement of library outreach and resources that cater specifically to the needs and interests of those from the African Diaspora. We aim to do the following: educate, inspire, and empower our members and the iSchool community through workshops and speaker series; provide a platform for Black voices in librarianship in allied professions to be heard; and create inclusive spaces that foster engagement, dialogue, and learning.

Joining the BSLC offers a unique opportunity to be part of a movement passionate about making a difference. Whether you are interested in research, community outreach, event planning, or want to learn more about black culture and history, there is a place for you here.

Cyber Intelligence & Security (CIS)

The Cyber Intelligence and Security Club at San José State University is committed to developing the next generation of cybersecurity professionals by fostering the development of knowledge, skills, and abilities through projects, competitions, professional networking, and industry presentations.

- CIS Club Website

First Generation Student Group (FGSG)

We are the First Generation Student Group at the SJSU iSchool. We define first-gen as being the first in your family or chosen family to attend graduate school (however that manifests for you, whether it's first female, first on your father's side, or first in your entire extended family).

We aim to have a tight-knit community of first generation SJSU iSchool students that look to each other for academic, social, and professional support as they navigate graduate school. We have monthly Coffee and Chat Zoom meetings with varying topics related to first-gen issues like going through resources we've found helpful, or sharing first job or application process experiences; however, many of the leadership team members are always open to one on one conversations if that's what you need. We also have a General Meeting once per term in place of the coffee and chat where we interview a first-gen faculty member and hold a Q&A with them about their experiences as a first-gen and we try to keep an ongoing list of helpful resources for first-gen students on our website and/or blog, so they can be accessed outside of our meetings.

Our group is pretty informal, we just enjoy networking with each other, and being able to discuss our shared experiences, and offer advice and support to each other. We'd love to have you join us. If you're interested in joining the first-gen student group, you can reach out to us on our socials, email us, or head over to our website to join the mailing list! We hope to see you soon!

- FGSG Website

REFORMA SJSU iSchool Student and Alumni Group

REFORMA San José State University (SJSU) School of Information (iSchool) Student & Alumni Group will cultivate a welcoming environment to develop, engage, and support students and alumni who are interested in working with Spanish-speaking communities. We strive to create opportunities for engagement with REFORMA National, and REFORMA Chapters, and plan activities that offer professional development and networking. We support students and alumni to become culturally competent professionals in the communities they serve.

- REFORMA SJSU iSchool Student and Alumni Group Website

Society of American Archivists Student Chapter (SAASC)

The Society of American Archivists – Student Chapter (affectionately known as SAASC, pronounced “sassy”) strives to promote archival interests in our academic community, to provide a platform for discussing archival issues, and to engage students in professional activities in order to enhance career development. Our group represents the Society of American Archivists (SAA), the largest national organization of archivists in the United States, for the SJSU iSchool student body: we welcome all MLIS and MARA students to join, and we aim to incorporate as many of SAA’s tools and resources into our programming and communication as possible.

- SAASC Website

Special Libraries Association Student Chapter (SLASC)

The Special Libraries Association Student Chapter (SLASC) believes that special librarians – those working in specialized settings – have unique and important skills to contribute at the highest levels of the profession, including the ability to help implement best practices within their organizations. SLASC members connect with their umbrella organization, the Special Libraries Association, which has members and chapters across the United States and in over 75 countries. Through student leadership opportunities, educational programming, members communications, virtual study groups and social events, SLASC cultivates meaningful, lasting connections among iSchool students and with the broader special library world.

- SLASC Website

Sports Analytics Club

The Sports Analytics Club at San José State University is sponsored by the iSchool and has a mission to provide students hands-on experience in a sports analytics environment with the assistance of faculty by analyzing and producing relevant data to SJSU athletic teams, in order to improve their on-field performance. The club has partnered with the baseball team in the past, with a goal to expand to other sports. We are looking to incorporate new technologies and programs along the way to make the most of the information that is made available to us. Opportunities to travel with a team(s) will be available, and all students and faculty members are welcome. Please do not hesitate to contact us on social media or via email. We look forward to meeting with you!

Contact Information:

- Andrew (Andy) MacKay: Club President andrew.mackay@sjsu.edu
- José Aguiñaga: Co-Faculty Advisor jose.aguinaga@sjsu.edu
- Crystal Fausett: Co-Faculty Advisor crystal.fausett@sjsu.edu
- Anthony Chow: School of Information Director a.chow@sjsu.edu

Student Research Journal (SRJ)

The Student Research Journal (SRJ) is the foremost double-blind, peer-reviewed, open-access journal developed and led by current graduate students at San Jose State University's School of information. Our goal is threefold: to empower budding researchers, to publish relevant content of the highest quality, and to build an international community of student researchers. The SRJ concentrates on providing students with deep developmental editing during the peer review process. Our goal is not to simply publish pieces that meet the baseline criteria, but to compliment your graduate-level studies with an immersive experience of the peer review process.

- SRJ Website

User Experience Student Group (UXSG)

The User Experience Student Group at SJSU iSchool (UXSG) exists to bring together MLIS, MARA, Informatics and BSISDA students who are interested in User Experience, though all iSchool students are welcome! UXSG aims to bring together those interested in usability from all backgrounds. We offer study sessions, webinars, and speaker events. Whether you're already familiar with user experience (UX) as a concept or are brand new to the field, UXSG is excited to hear from you!

- UXSG Website
- Join our Discord Channel

Virtual Worlds & Social VR Club (VCARA)

The iSchool's Virtual Center for Archives and Records Administration (VCARA) began as a student group in our MARA program in 2009, but has evolved into an informal club open to all (students, alumni, faculty, staff, and other remote friends/colleagues). We promote social, creative, and educational collaboration using multiple virtual environments; from desktop virtual worlds (like our beloved Second Life region) to platforms accessed with VR headsets.

If you're the adventurous type interested in virtual worlds, virtual reality, and related aspects of information science (including archives, education and libraries), you'll fit right in. Best of all, no special equipment is needed. Read more at our website, connect

with us on Discord, and come hangout with us in-world at conferences, events, explorer outings, or end of semester dance parties.

- VCARA Website
- Join our Discord Channel

Women in Cybersecurity, San Jose State University Student Chapter

Women in Cybersecurity is a national organization dedicated to the recruitment, retention and advancement of women in the cybersecurity field. The organization's mission is to "recruit, retain and advance women in cybersecurity to build a robust and diverse cybersecurity workforce" with a vision of "[a] world where cybersecurity workforce is an inclusive space" (Source: Women in Cybersecurity national website).

The club is open to women, as well as others who wish to be allies toward reaching these goals.

San Jose State University has just become a student chapter. It will be known as the Women in Cybersecurity, San Jose State University Student Chapter. The organization is open to all SJSU students, undergraduate and graduate, both on campus and from the iSchool. You can learn more about the chapter here.

Award-winning Student Chapters

The SJSU iSchool's student chapters have won numerous awards recognizing their excellence and their innovative approach to serving online students. The ASIS&T Student Chapter has been named the association's Student Chapter of the Year. The SLA Student Chapter has received the organization's Student Group Certificate of Merit for Innovative Programming. The SLA Student Chapter was the only U.S. student group to be recognized for the 2014/2015 academic year. In addition, the ALA Student Chapter has been named Student Chapter of the Year five times!

Get Involved

Many of the school's student groups host meet-ups, special events, and networking opportunities – both virtual and in-person. Check the SJSU iSchool Facebook page often for updates about upcoming events and the Pinterest board for fun pins. The SJSU iSchool student groups also have their own social media. In addition, the student-run *Student Research Journal* editorial team manages a Student Resource blog.

Travel Funds for Student Groups

Student Travel Process

Per University policy, if a student is traveling for the sole purpose of professional development, i.e., not presenting on behalf of the school, not helping with an iSchool event – the travel reimbursement will be processed through the Financial Aid and Scholarship Office upon completion of travel.

Upon conclusion of your travel:

- Email the Administrative Analyst, Roffna Principe (roffna.principe@sjsu.edu)a list of your expenses with copies of your receipts.
- Your payment request will be submitted to the Financial Aid and Scholarship Office and will disburse to your student account once the process is completed.

If, while traveling to this conference, the student is also representing the School of Information or assisting the School of Information with an event, the student will be reimbursed via a Travel Authorization.

Travel Reimbursement Process:

- As soon as you know you are going to travel, submit the Student Group Travel Request form.
- Once you are awarded the grant, the Administrative Analyst will initiate a travel authorization for you.
    - This will come via DocuSign – unless you are a student employee, in this case, you will receive it via FTS.
    - This must be done a minimum of 30 days prior to the date of travel.
- Complete Student Travel Informed Consent Risk Management Form.
- Email the complete form to the Administrative Analyst
- Email the completed forms to the Administrative Analyst, Roffna Principe (roffna.principe@sjsu.edu).
- The Administrative Analyst will review the information for accuracy and compliance, and will submit the Request for Approval of Travel for the required approvals.
- Students will be notified once the Request for Approval of Travel is approved.
- Students will make their own travel arrangements.
- Students must pay for the related expenses, and will then be reimbursed for qualified travel expenses.

- Keep all of your receipts while traveling. You cannot be reimbursed for expenses with missing receipts.
- Once travel has taken place, all receipts must be submitted to the Administrative Analyst, who will then complete the Travel Expense Claim form.
- You will be reimbursed for your qualified expenses up to the amount of your travel grant.
- Receipts must be submitted within 30 days of the conclusion of travel.
- If the receipt is vague, provide an explanation.
- Scan all your receipts, use the Travel Reimbursement Receipts Log to organize them, and email them to the Administrative Analyst, Roffna Principe (roffna.principe@sjsu.edu).
- The Administrative Analyst will submit the Travel Expense Claim form and the receipts for approval and reimbursement processing.
- Once the Travel Expense Claim is processed by Payment Services, a check will be issued and mailed to the student's address unless the student has submitted an Employee Reimbursement Direct Deposit Authorization form to Accounts Payable (even if you are a student). See: https://blogs.sjsu.edu/financeconnect/2020/08/04/employee-reimbursement-direct-deposit/

Coursera Career Academy – Free for All Students

Added Value for Your Degree

The SJSU School of Information knows the importance of lifelong learning and the need to stay competitive in the job market. That's why our school has partnered with Coursera, a global online learning platform, to enhance our students' career preparation with recognized industry certificates at no additional cost.

The Coursera Career Academy's online courses, micro-credentials, and certificates from world-class companies are offered free-of-charge to all iSchool students, alumni, faculty, and staff, and serve to expand their learning beyond their iSchool program.

Unlock Your Potential

From data science and computer science to business and information technology, the Career Academy courses cover in-demand fields and teach the skills employers seek in job candidates. Students can also explore different career paths and find the right role for their career goals, earn a micro-credential from a leading company, prepare for a career change, and receive expert instruction from industry leaders, including Google, Meta, IBM, Salesforce, and more.

Career Academy Popular Topics

- Information Security
- Cloud Security
- Python
- Database Management
- Business Intelligence
- Project Management
- Risk Management
- Communication Skills

Asynchronous and Self-Paced

All of the Career Academy courses are delivered online at no cost and many have flexible completion timelines. Students and alumni can learn at their own pace. While records of completion are permanently held by Coursera, access to the Career Academy will expire automatically one year after students graduate and one year after alumni register for the courses. Access to the Career Academy can be renewed annually if there is no waiting list.

Expand Your iSchool Education

Students and alumni are highly encouraged to take advantage of this incredible opportunity to broaden their skills and knowledge and get job ready.

Stand Out in the Job Market

- Select from more than 30 professional certificates
- Explore 50+ high-paying, in-demand career paths
- Numerous courses and certificate offerings with no pre-requisites
- Earn valuable industry credentials
- Build your network among leading companies like Google, Meta, and IBM

Sign Up for Coursera Career Academy

We are thrilled to be able to provide our students and alumni with these additional learning opportunities to strengthen employment options. Enrollment in the Coursera Career Academy is reserved for students, alumni, faculty and staff of the SJSU School of Information only.

Current Students

The Coursera licenses for current students will begin in May 2024. After which, the iSchool will send an email to current students enrolled in the Master of Library and Information Science, Master of Archives and Records Administration, Master of Science in Informatics, Bachelor of Science in Information Science and Data Analytics, and Gateway PhD programs inviting them to opt in to take Coursera courses. The email will be sent at the beginning of each semester to the email address on file and include instructions on how to gain access to the Coursera courses.

Alumni

iSchool will be emailing out an online application form to alumni twice a year: once in the Summer, and once in the Winter. Completing the online application form will allow alumni to opt in for a one-year Coursera Career Academy license. A limited number of licenses will be made available to alumni on a first-come basis until all seats are allocated. Alumni who are granted a license will receive an invitation email directly from Coursera. Follow the instructions in the email to join the Alumni Learning Program.

Faculty and Staff

Faculty and staff Coursera invitations were sent out in early June 2024. If you did not receive one, and would like to access Coursera as an iSchool faculty or staff member, please contact Abigail Laufer.

Technical Support

We are committed to your success and are here to help if you encounter any technical problems related to Coursera Career Academy. Please fill out and submit the iSchool Tech Support Form, and we'll troubleshoot the issue.

Coursera Career Academy – Registration

iSchool users should review this page prior to clicking on the Coursera Career Academy registration link that they received via email.

Section #1 below includes critical registration guidelines. Please review these guidelines prior to advancing to Section #2, which contains an overview of the registration process.

Read more

FAQs – Coursera Career Academy

Q. Who is eligible to take Coursera courses?
A. Coursera courses will be made available to current students enrolled in the Master of Library and Information Science, Master of Archives and Records Administration, Master of Science in Informatics, Bachelor of Science in Information Science and Data Analytics, and Gateway PhD programs. A limited number of licenses will also be reserved for alumni of these programs.

Read more

MLIS Career Pathways – Relevant Professional Certificates

These professional certificates can complement the MLIS curriculum by helping students validate skills commonly requested in LIS job descriptions. They can help students translate their library science knowledge into industry-recognized skills and round out their individual skillsets, making them competitive candidates for evolving roles in the information profession.

Academic Librarianship

- Google UX Design & Microsoft UX Design

Strong UX skills can help ensure that students and faculty can find resources easily on library websites and that the user experience across library platforms is smooth.

- IBM Data Analyst & Google Data Analytics

These certificates teach foundational data & analytical skills, enabling students to effectively consult with researchers and assist faculty in managing their research data.

Strong data skills can also help students in their decision-making and evaluation of programs & resources.

- Google Project Management

Project management skills are useful for any role. This certificate gives students frameworks and strategies for managing multi-stakeholder projects and programs effectively.

Archives and Preservation

- Google Project Management

This certificate teaches students how to plan and execute complex initiatives, such as digitizing large sets of records and managing collections. It also covers frameworks for managing projects within a team and strategies for effective communication.

- Google Data Analytics

This certificate is useful for learning how to clean and interpret data. Strong data analysis skills can help students identify patterns in how collections are used and organize records more effectively.

- Microsoft Python Development

This certificate teaches foundational coding skills in Python. Python is helpful for automation of tasks, data analysis, and working with digital files and databases.

Data Science

- IBM Data Science

This certificate covers the entire data lifecycle, from data collection to predictive modeling. Students will learn skills in data visualization, statistical analysis, predictive modeling, machine learning algorithms, and data mining. Languages, tools, and libraries include Python, SQL, Jupyter notebooks, Github, Rstudio, Pandas, Numpy, ScikitLearn, Matplotlib, and more.

- IBM Data Analytics with Excel and R

By focusing on Excel and R, this certificate familiarizes students with common research tools and gives them the skills necessary to use them effectively.

- Google Data Analytics

This certificate covers the core practical skills of the data lifecycle, including data cleaning, analysis, and visualization. It serves as a strong foundation for turning raw information into actionable insights.

- Fractal Data Science

This certificate emphasizes problem-solving with data. It prepares students to use data for strategic decision-making and to translate complex analysis into clear narratives for stakeholders. Students will also learn tools like SQL, PowerBI, and Python.

- Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst

This certificate provides specialized training in Power BI, a widely used industry tool for data analysis and visualization. It teaches students how to communicate and present data in a way that allows stakeholders to understand insights easily.

- Tableau Business Intelligence Analyst

This certificate provides specialized training in Tableau, another widely used tool for data analysis and visualization. It also teaches students how to communicate data clearly to help stakeholders understand complex trends.

- IBM Data Management

This certificate teaches the technical skills needed to build and maintain the repositories where data is stored. It covers how to structure raw data so it remains accessible and secure for the long term.

Digital Curation

- Google Project Management

Digital curation involves complex, multi-stage initiatives like migrating collections or establishing new preservation services. This certificate provides the frameworks to plan and execute these projects effectively.

- Google Data Analytics

This certificate gives students a strong foundation in the practical skills of cleaning, processing, and evaluating datasets. Strong analysis skills can enable students to make informed decisions regarding the digital curation projects they manage.

- IBM Data Management

This certificate teaches the technical skills needed to build and maintain data repositories. It helps students understand the architecture of databases they may work with and covers managing large sets of data and ensuring data integrity.

Digital Services

- Google UX Design & Microsoft UX Design

These UX Design certificates provide the essential frameworks for building digital platforms that are intuitive for patrons. They prepare students to analyze user needs and design virtual library sites & resources that are user-friendly and accessible.

- Adobe Graphic Designer

This certificate equips students with the skills to create visually engaging assets, which can be useful for the creation and marketing of digital exhibits, online collections, and library services.

Emerging Technologies

- Google Project Management

This certificate provides the universal project management skills needed to lead Emerging Technologies initiatives effectively from the initial planning to a successful launch.

- Google Data Analytics

The ability to interpret data and make informed decisions is useful for assessing and adopting new tools. This certificate helps students develop core data analysis skills that can be used to identify opportunities and evaluate the impact of emerging technologies on library services.

Note: Coursera's Career Academy also has individual courses related to Artificial Intelligence which may be useful as well. See "GenAI in Career Academy" tab.

Information Intermediation

- Google Project Management

This certificate teaches project management fundamentals that can be helpful in leading information intermediation initiatives effectively, such as managing communication with diverse stakeholders, strategic planning, and adapting to changes.

Information Organization

- Google Project Management

This certificate teaches key skills needed to lead information organization projects, such as coordinating system migrations, setting timelines, and managing technical teams.

- Google Data Analytics & IBM Data Analyst

These certificates give students a strong foundation in practical data analysis skills, helping them evaluate the performance of library services and make informed decisions about the programs they manage.

Leadership and Management

- Google Project Management & IBM Project Management

These certificates provide structured frameworks to help leaders plan resources and coordinate complex initiatives. They also teach communication and stakeholder management skills useful for leading teams toward common goals. Google's project management course is more agnostic whereas IBM Project Management is more focused on preparation for the CAPM certification.

- Microsoft Program Management & IBM Program Manager

These certificates build the advanced strategic planning skills necessary to oversee multiple related projects. This is useful for ensuring consistent delivery and aligning diverse library services with the institution's broader mission. Both professional certificates can help prepare students for the PgMP exam.

Public Librarianship

- Google Project Management

Public librarians can serve as community programming coordinators and are also now being tasked to manage a variety of different programs and initiatives. This certificate provides the structured frameworks needed to lead and execute those projects effectively.

- Meta Social Media Marketing

Libraries are increasingly using social media to engage with their community and market their services. Having a strong understanding of how to effectively use social media to support library goals, help increase patronage, and promote the library's brand online.

- Adobe Content Creator & Adobe Graphic Designer

These certificates provide students with a toolkit for effective visual communication. They can enable librarians to design professional, engaging instructional and marketing materials that represent the library well.

School Librarianship

- Google Project Management

This certificate provides the project management skills needed to lead school library initiatives effectively, such as coordinating book fairs, managing budgets, and executing collaborative lesson plans with teachers.

- Adobe Content Creator & Adobe Graphic Designer

These certificates provide students with a toolkit for effective visual communication. Students can learn how to design professional, engaging instructional materials, presentations, and newsletters related to library goals.

Special Librarianship

- Google Project Management

This certificate teaches the core skills needed to lead any kind of project or initiative effectively. Students will learn how to manage communication with different parties and create and execute well thought out plans.

Web Programming

- Meta Front-End Developer

This certificate covers HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and React. It also teaches students how to use industry-standard tools such as Bootstrap, React, and Figma.

- Meta Back-End Developer

This certificate covers Python, Linux, Git, MySQL/SQL, REST APIs. It also teaches API development.

- Microsoft Python Development

This certificate develops student proficiency in Python. Covers the basics to advanced concepts like generative AI and cloud computing

- Google UX Design & Microsoft UX Design

These certificates teach user-centered design and key UX/UI skills such as prototyping and testing usability, which can apply to developing library websites and systems in an accessible and inclusive way.

Youth Services

- Google Project Management

This certificate teaches core project management skills that can help students coordinate and execute youth services programs and outreach efforts effectively.

- Goodwill® Career Coach and Navigator

This certificate could offer transferable skills for guiding young individuals, and covers areas such as coaching, client relations, conducting needs assessments, and building community partnerships.

MS in Instructional Design and Technology: Recommended Professional Certificates

By adding these credentials to their degree, MS IDT students can demonstrate proficiency in current industry tools, complement their academic knowledge, and build job-ready skills employers are looking for.

Instructional Design & Learning Experience

(Target Careers: Instructional Designer, Learning Experience Designer, UX Designer for Learning Tech, E-Learning Developer)

- Google UX Design & Microsoft UX Design

These certificates teach core User Experience principles that can help students design intuitive and accessible learning interfaces and educational platforms.

- Adobe Content Creator & Adobe Graphic Designer

Instructional Designers are often expected to be their own multimedia specialists. These certificates provide the visual design skills needed to create professional-looking e-learning modules, training decks, and infographics.

Project Management & Leadership

(Target Careers: L&D Manager, K-12 School District Curriculum/Instructional Technology Director, Academic Program Manager, Corporate Trainer / L&D Specialist, Educational Technology Specialist, Instructional Technology Coordinator, Digital Learning Consultant)

- Google Project Management

This certificate teaches foundational project management skills and strategies to manage scope of instructional design projects, coordinate with Subject Matter Experts, and ensure that complex training initiatives are delivered on time and within budget.

- Microsoft Program Management

For students aiming for leadership roles or would like to build on foundational project management skills, this certificate moves beyond individual projects to organizational strategy. It teaches how to align training programs with broader business goals and manage resources across multiple departments.

Data-Centered Design & Evaluation

(Target Careers: Human Performance Consultant, Educational Technology Specialist, L&D Specialist, Instructional Technology Coordinator, Digital Learning Consultant)

- Google Data Analytics

This certificate equips students with the skills to measure learning outcomes and evaluate program effectiveness. It teaches the analysis skills helpful for students in assessing the impact of programs and proving ROI using data.

- Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst / Tableau Business Intelligence Analyst

L&D leaders often need to present training metrics to stakeholders. These certificates teach students how to visualize learner data and performance gaps in clear, actionable dashboards that administration and C-suite executives can easily understand. Power BI and Tableau are some of the most common industry-standard tools for data visualization.

Technical Development & E-Learning

(Target Careers: E-Learning Developer, Gamification Designer)

- Meta Front-End Developer

This certificate teaches how students can use HTML5, CSS, and JavaScript to build websites and applications. Learning these skills can help give students a competitive advantage by teaching them how they can create custom web-based training programs.

Corporate Training & Development

(Target Careers: Corporate Trainer, Career Coach, Human Performance Consultant)

- Goodwill® Career Coach and Navigator

This certificate could offer some transferable skills for students as it covers coaching, conducting needs assessments, and supporting individual professional development plans.

MS Informatics – Relevant Professional Certificates

These professional certificates focus on applied technical skills and current industry tools. Each certificate requires the completion of hands-on projects, such as deploying web applications, auditing security protocols, or analyzing datasets, which can provide students with tangible evidence of competency for their personal professional portfolios.

INFM 201: Tech Foundations

- Meta Back-End Developer

This certificate teaches skills & languages such as Python, Linux, Git, mySQL/SQL, Django, and REST APIs.

- Meta Front-End Developer

This certificate teaches how to code and build interactive web pages using HTML5, CSS and JavaScript. Students will use industry-standard tools such as Bootstrap, React, and Figma.

INFM 202: Security Overview

- Google Cybersecurity

This certificate covers Python, Linux, SQL, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) tools, Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS), communication, collaboration, analysis, problem solving and more! It also helps students prepare for the CompTIA Security+ exam.

- IBM Cybersecurity Analyst

This certificate covers penetration testing, incident response, forensics, and threat intelligence.Students will also develop cybersecurity plans and compliance frameworks. This also helps students prepare for the CompTIA Security+ exam.

- IBM and ISC2 Cybersecurity Specialist Professional Certificate

This certificate focuses on cybersecurity skills such as threat mitigation, access control, incident response, and disaster recovery planning. This helps students prepare for the ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity exam.

INFM 203: Big Data Analytics

- IBM Data Science

This certificate prepares students for in-demand skills including data visualization, statistical analysis, predictive modeling, machine learning algorithms, and data mining. They will also work with languages, tools, and libraries including Python, SQL, Jupyter notebooks, Github, Rstudio, Pandas, Numpy, ScikitLearn, Matplotlib, and more.

- IBM Data Engineering

This certificate teaches the core skills needed to build the systems and infrastructure that collects and processes large-scale data sets. Students will learn SQL, RDBMS, ETL, Data Warehousing, NoSQL, Big Data, and Spark.

INFM 204: Human Centered Design

- Google UX Design

This certificate covers core UX design topics and guides students through the end-to-end UX process of researching, wireframing, and testing. Focuses on foundational UX design principles.

- Microsoft UX Design

This certificate teaches core UX design topics with a focus on building systems that are accessible to all users.

- IBM UI/UX Designer

This certificate teaches core UX design topics with a focus on enterprise design thinking and tech/dev alignment.

INFM 205: Project Management

- IBM Project Manager

This certificate teaches project management skills with an emphasis on IT-specific scenarios and working with technical teams. This also helps students prepare for the CAPM certification exam.

- Microsoft Project Management

This certificate teaches core project management skills and prepares students for the PMP exam.

- Microsoft Program Management & IBM Program Manager

These certificates build on foundational project management skills and cover aligning multiple projects with organizational strategy. Students can also prepare for the PgMP certification exam. The IBM certificate focuses slightly more on methodologies while the Microsoft certificate focuses slightly more on leadership and operations.

INFM 206: Electronic Records & INFM 207: Digital Assets Management

- IBM Data Management

This certificate can complement these courses by teaching foundational data management concepts and the technical architecture of databases. It could be useful

for students if they are interested in rounding out their skillset to learn industry-standard data tools and understand how to build and maintain the repositories where electronic records and digital assets live.

INFM 208: Information Assurance

- IBM & ISC2 Cybersecurity Specialist

This certificate covers core security principles, incident response, and disaster recovery planning. It provides the foundational knowledge needed to understand how risk management frameworks are applied to protect digital data.

- Microsoft Cybersecurity Analyst

This certificate focuses on the technical skills required to enforce security policies and protect organizational assets, particularly within an Azure environment.

Relevant AI Content in Career Academy

Nearly 1 in 4 U.S. tech jobs posted in 2025 require AI skills[1], and 86% of employers expect AI to transform their operations by 2030[2]. The ability to understand and leverage Generative AI tools will be important for any student, regardless of the discipline or degree they are pursuing. Below is a current list of courses available within Coursera's Career Academy catalog.

Curated Courses Focused Solely on Foundational AI Concepts

- (IBM) Introduction to Artificial Intelligence (AI)
- (IBM) Generative AI: Prompt Engineering Basics
- (IBM) Generative AI: Introductions and Applications
- (IBM) Generative AI: Foundation Models and Platforms

Curated Courses Focused Solely on AI & Applications

- (Adobe) Generative AI Content Creation
- (IBM) Machine Learning with Apache Spark
- (Fractal Analytics) Advanced Machine Learning Algorithms
- (IBM) Developing AI Applications with Python and Flask
- (IBM) Generative AI: Boost Your Cybersecurity Career
- (IBM) Generative AI: Elevate your Data Engineering Career
- (IBM) Generative AI: Elevate Your Data Science Career

- (IBM) Generative AI: Enhance your Data Analytics Career

All AI-Related Content in Career Academy

- LINKED HERE

This includes courses that have artificial intelligence and machine learning as skill attributes but may not be purely focused on AI.

Please be sure to navigate to the “AI Content in Career Academy” tab

Graduation Application Process and Forms

Master's degree students must complete and submit two required SJSU steps by the posted deadlines for the semester of planned graduation.

- Step 1 Candidacy Approval form
- Step 2 Application for Award of Graduate Degree process done through MySJSU

Make sure you read and understand the instructions for the two separate steps since they will be submitted differently to different offices.

When to Start the Process

The Candidacy Approval form can be submitted at any time after you have completed nine units.* While GAPE's deadline to submit is approximately 4–5 months before the beginning of the semester you plan to graduate, School of Information sets an earlier due date prior to the GAPE due date. This is because we need time to review your submitted form, have it signed by the iSchool Coordinator of Admissions and Academic Advising, and send it to the Graduate Admissions and Program Evaluations office (GAPE) by their posted deadline. GAPE will give the final and official approval or denial. Once the Candidacy form is approved by GAPE, the student will be prompted through their MySJSU account to complete the graduation application (Step 2) online.

*Note: Students who submit their Candidacy plan earlier than 6 months prior to the iSchool submission dates may have a longer wait for their form to be approved at SJSU GAPE, due to how the GAPE office prioritizes processing forms.

The Application for Award of Master's Degree form is usually due at the start of the semester you plan to graduate. It is your responsibility to keep track of these deadline dates and submit all forms before the deadline for that form. These deadlines are set by

the University and are not flexible. There is no recourse for a missed deadline. Missing a deadline means that SJSU will delay your effective graduation date to a future semester.

See the left menu for directions on completing both steps.

Tools to Help Complete the Graduation Application Process

iSchool Graduation Checklist

Video Overview of the Graduation Process

Also make sure to go to the Graduate Admissions and Program Evaluations office (GAPE) site at sjsu.edu/gape/ and read the Current Students/Steps for Completing Your Master's Degree and the Frequently Asked Questions sections for more information about acceptable grades, required academic standing, transcripts, diplomas, etc.

Per the office of Graduate Admissions & Program Evaluations (GAPE), it takes a while following graduation to have degrees posted to transcripts. You will receive an email from GAPE when your degree has been awarded and posted on your transcript. Calling the GAPE office staff before then slows down the process for everyone and does not result in your own degree getting posted more rapidly. Please DO NOT CONTACT the GAPE office or staff for the two months following the month you graduate. However, you can check your status on MySJSU under "Other Indicators" or check your unofficial transcript from time to time. The graduation processing timeline is:

Spring: late June – late July

Fall: late January – end of February

Summer: Mid September – late October

Candidacy Approval Form Information

This form is formally called the Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy. It tells SJSU that your department is advancing you for review for candidacy for a graduate degree.

Note: Students are to upload this form to the iSchool Candidacy form — do not send this form directly to the Graduate Admissions and Program Evaluations office (GAPE). Do Not FAX to the iSchool — FAXes will not be accepted.

Read more

Changing Graduation Date

The Graduation Date Change Request is now online!

If you change the date you plan to graduate after you have submitted an Application for Award of Graduate Degree through your MySJSU account, you must submit a Change of Graduation Date Form online. The $10.00 change fee is currently suspended.

Graduation Date Change Request Online Form

Read more

Changing Planned Courses

If you take classes other than the ones listed on your approved candidacy form (change in catalog number or unit value), you must file a Course Substitution Form.

Read more

Completing The MARA Candidacy Approval Form

Note: The SJSU Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy form has changed. Please be sure you are using the most current form, available from this location.

Quick Links:

Read more

Completing the MLIS Candidacy Approval Form

Note: The SJSU Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy form has changed. Please be sure you are using the most current form, available from this location.

Read more

Completing the MS in Informatics Candidacy Approval Form

Note: The SJSU Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy form has changed. Please be sure you are using the most current form, available from this location.

Read more

Application for Award of Graduate Degree Online Process

Must be completed online by the posted deadline **Paper forms are no longer accepted by GAPE**

- Due date for May graduation: February 1
- Due date for August graduation: March 1
- Due date for December graduation: September 1

You must apply to graduate with GAPE for graduation after your candidacy has been approved.

First-time Applicants:

Read more

Awards for Excellence for Graduating Students

The Ken Haycock Award for Exceptional Professional Promise

Open for applications February 1 – February 28

Read more

Onsite Graduation Ceremony Spring 2026

Congratulations!

The SJSU School of Information students participate in the onsite university commencement ceremony held **by the college twice a year (in fall for fall graduates and in spring for spring and summer graduates)**. Graduates from fall, spring and summer will receive information from SJSU Commencement inviting them to participate in university-wide celebration events for all university graduates.

Read more

Virtual Graduation Celebration

iSchool graduates can choose to participate in any or all of the three virtual opportunities iSchool provides to honor graduates: 1. Virtual Graduation Zoom Celebration, 2. Graduate Video, 3. Virtual Graduation Website.

For information about the onsite ceremony, see the onsite graduation page of our website.

Read more

Candidacy Approval Form Information

This form is formally called the Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy. It tells SJSU that your department is advancing you for review for candidacy for a graduate degree.

Note: Students are to upload this form to the iSchool Candidacy form — do not send this form directly to the Graduate Admissions and Program Evaluations office (GAPE). Do Not FAX to the iSchool — FAXes will not be accepted.

Students **do not need** to have their own advisors sign this form. The iSchool will download your Candidacy Form from your submission, obtain necessary signatures, and then forward it to GAPE.

In most cases, the School of Information sets the due date prior to the GAPE due date. This is because we need time to review your submitted form, have it signed by the iSchool Coordinator of Admissions and Academic Advising, and send it to the Graduate Admissions and Program Evaluations office (GAPE) by their posted deadline. GAPE will give the final and official approval or denial.

Note: Students who submit their Candidacy plan earlier than 6 months prior to the iSchool submission dates may have a longer wait for their form to be approved at SJSU GAPE, due to how the GAPE office prioritizes processing forms.

Due Dates for Submission to iSchool

For May graduation, submit to iSchool by September 24.
For August graduation, submit to iSchool by December 1.
For December graduation, submit to iSchool by March 25.

How to Fill Out:

Follow the appropriate link details on how to fill out this form online and save it to your computer for uploading to the iSchool webform:

- MLIS Candidacy Approval form instructions
- MARA Candidacy Approval form instructions
- MS in Informatics Candidacy Approval form instructions

How to Submit:

Digitally sign and upload your saved form to the iSchool Candidacy Form.

The **iSchool Graduation Checklist** can walk you through the administrative steps toward completing your degree. For questions, contact the Student Services Team.

Once approved, do not submit this form again. To make changes, submit a substitution form.

Changing Graduation Date

The Graduation Date Change Request is now online!

If you change the date you plan to graduate after you have submitted an Application for Award of Graduate Degree through your MySJSU account, you must submit a Change of Graduation Date Form online. The $10.00 change fee is currently suspended.

Graduation Date Change Request Online Form

Once a student submits the online graduate date change request, a confirmation email will be sent to the student.

Changing Planned Courses

If you take classes other than the ones listed on your approved candidacy form (change in catalog number or unit value), you must file a Course Substitution Form. If you are only changing the semester that you take the course, not the actual course, it is not necessary to submit the form. Students may not drop a class from their Candidacy that has already been graded. Please note the following sample scenarios:

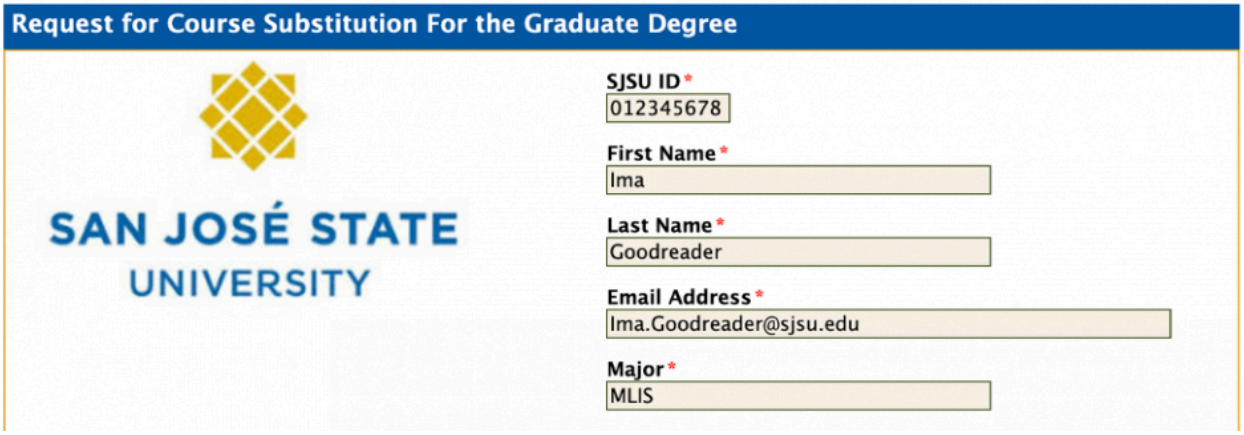
- I included INFO 220 on my candidacy but ended up taking INFO 281 the same semester. ***Yes!*** *Submit a course substitution.*
- I included INFO 244 on my candidacy for Spring 2021 but ended up taking it in Fall 2021. ***No.*** *You do not need a course substitution if only the term has changed.*
- I included MARA 284 for 3 units on my candidacy but ended up taking it for 2 units. ***Yes!*** *Submit a course substitution if the unit value has changed. Don't forget to add another class for the remaining unit.*
- I included INFO 246 (Topic: Information Visualization) but ended up taking INFO 246 (Topic: Information Architecture). ***No.*** *You do not need a course substitution for topic changes if there is no change in the catalog number or unit value of the class.*
- I included INFO 248 on my candidacy but did not pass the class. I ended up taking INFO 282 the following semester. ***Yes!*** *Submit a course substitution, but instead of dropping INFO 248, you would just add INFO 282 since you cannot drop a class that has already been graded.*

Note: Please WAIT to submit the form until you have actually enrolled in the substitution course. GAPE will reject your form unless you have actually enrolled

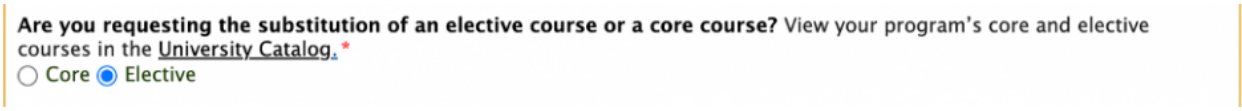
in the class in MySJSU (Being on a wait list does not constitute enrollment status).

How to Complete and Submit:

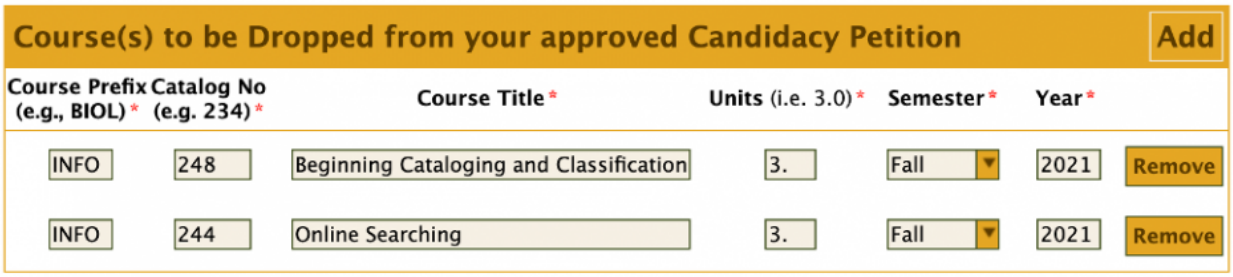
A. Open the Request for Course Substitution For the Graduate Degree form
B. Enter your personal information
(For “Major” enter the Degree Program you are in (INFM, MARA, MLIS)

C. 

D. Select “Elective” for the question “Are you requesting the substitution of an elective course or a core course?” (iSchool does not allow substitution of core courses)

E. 

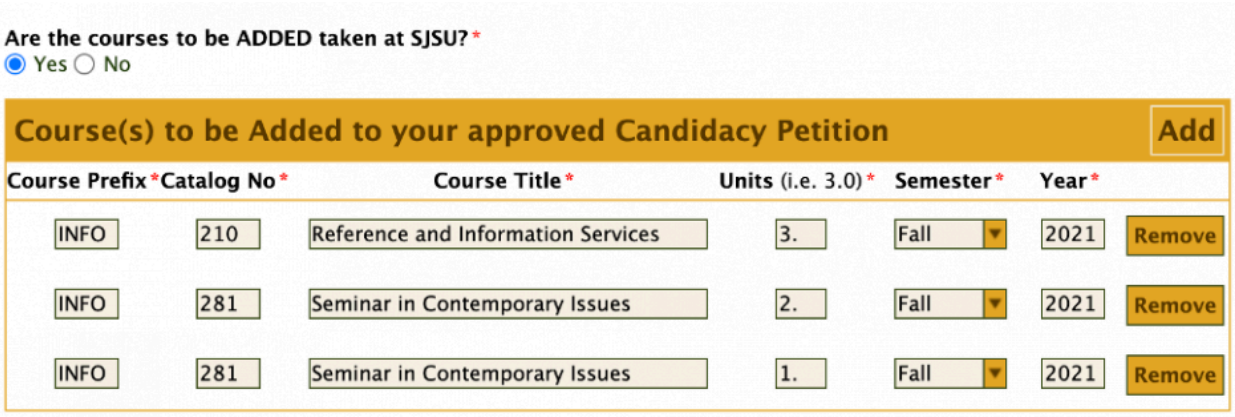
F. Enter the course(s) to be dropped from your candidacy (section numbers do not need to included). If you are dropping more than one class, click the “Add” button found on the right side of the gold banner.

G. 

H. Select “Yes” for “Are the courses to be ADDED taken at SJSU?” and enter the course(s) to be added to your candidacy (section numbers do not need to be included). If you are adding more than one class, click the “Add” button found on

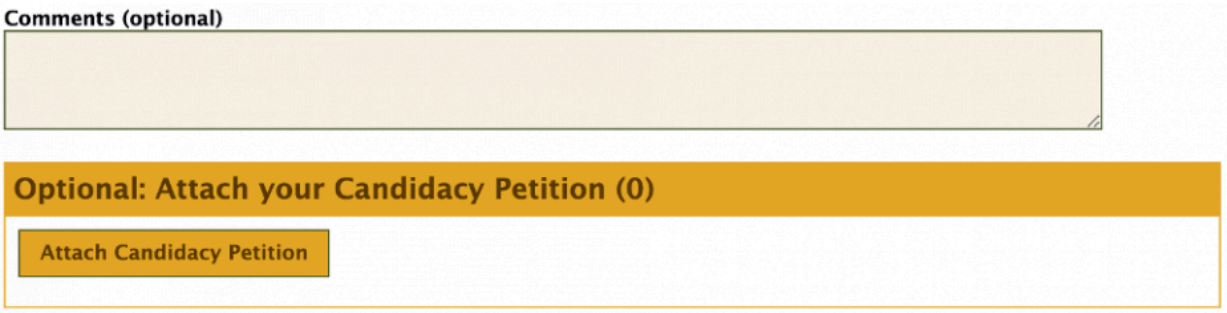
the right of the gold banner.

I.



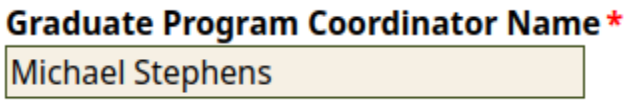
J. Leave the Comments blank and do not attach your candidacy petition unless directed to do so by GAPE.

K.

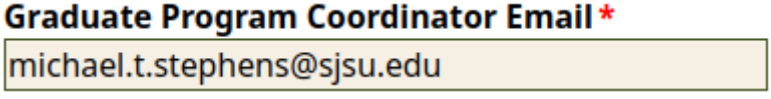


L. Enter Graduate Program Coordinator information. For all School of Information degree programs, the Graduate Program Coordinator is Dr. Michael Stephens (michael.t.stephens@sjsu.edu).

M.



N.



O. Click “Submit”

For questions, contact the Student Services Team.

Completing The MARA Candidacy Approval Form

Note: The SJSU Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy form has changed. Please be sure you are using the most current form, available from this location.

Quick Links:

1. Student Information
2. Degree Information
3. Proposed Graduate Degree Program
    - (Section A) Courses (excluding transfer courses)
    - (Section B) Culminating experience
    - (Section C) Transfer Courses
4. Required Signatures
5. How to Submit Your Candidacy Form
6. Tracking your Candidacy and Making Changes to your Approved Plan

This page contains instructions for MARA candidacy applicants. Instructions for MLIS candidacy applicants can be found on the page, Completing the MLIS Candidacy Approval Form. **Note: Your form will not be approved for candidacy if your CUM GPA is below 3.0**. **You must have 9 units of graded classes on your transcript before you may file a Candidacy form.**

Candidacy Approval Form. The requirements for completing this form are fairly strict. Following the instructions below will help you successfully complete the form and avoid the delays and problems associated with needing to resubmit it. You can view a sample completed form.

You will need the latest version of Adobe Acrobat Reader DC free to download). Be **sure** to:

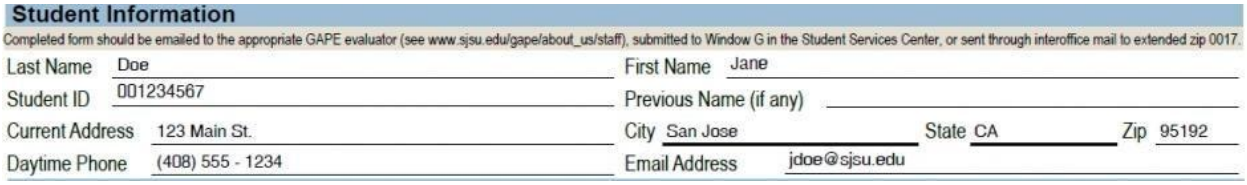
- Save the candidacy form onto your computer. Do not try to fill it in online, Adobe Reader will give you an error message if you try to use it to sign an online PDF
- Be sure to use Adobe Reader DC

You can also download the Adobe Creative Cloud Software (including Adobe Acrobat) that is free to students, but with restrictions and limitations based on semester enrollment.

1. OPEN the Candidacy Approval Form [PDF].
2. Do a **FILE/SAVE AS** to your computer, renaming the file as follows: [YOURLASTNAME_YOURFIRSTNAME_STUDENTIDNUMBER].pdf.
3. Open this file from your computer and, using Adobe Reader, TYPE directly into the form you see displayed on your computer screen.
4. SAVE to your computer desktop.
5. Upload the completed form to Canvas -see Steps to Submit the Candidacy Approval Form (below)

1. Student Information

Disregard the statement at the top of the form: “This completed form should be emailed to the appropriate GAPE evaluator, submitted to Window G in the Student Services Center, or sent through interoffice mail to extended zip 0017,” as you will be submitting the form to iSchool who will then gather necessary signatures and forward the form to GAPE directly on your behalf.



Student Information

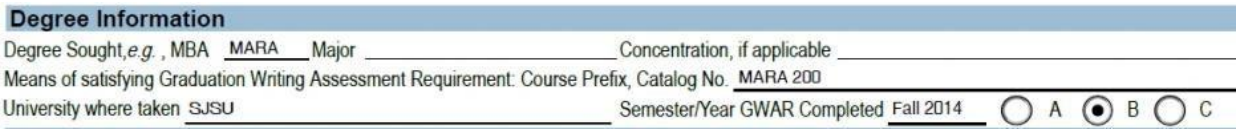
Completed form should be emailed to the appropriate GAPE evaluator (see www.sjsu.edu/gape/about_us/staff), submitted to Window G in the Student Services Center, or sent through interoffice mail to extended zip 0017.

Last Name	Doe	First Name	Jane
Student ID	001234567	Previous Name (if any)	
Current Address	123 Main St.	City San Jose State CA	Zip 95192
Daytime Phone	(408) 555 - 1234	Email Address	jdoe@sjsu.edu

1. Last Name/First Name, etc. — Click in the area marked “Last Name” and type in your last name. Complete the rest of this section by moving to each field and clicking in the area where you wish to type.
2. Student ID: Enter your MySJSU ID
3. Current Address, City, State and Zip: Enter your most up to date information in these fields.
4. Daytime Phone/ Email Address: Include your most recent telephone number and email address.

[top]

2. Degree Information



Degree Information

Degree Sought, *e.g.* , MBA MARA Major Concentration, if applicable

Means of satisfying Graduation Writing Assessment Requirement: Course Prefix, Catalog No. MARA 200

University where taken SJSU Semester/Year GWAR Completed Fall 2014 ○ A ◉ B ○ C

1. Degree Sought, e.g., MBA; Type in “MARA”.
2. Leave the Major and Concentration fields blank.
3. Means of satisfying GWAR Graduate Writing Assessment Requirement: type in “MARA 200.” For University: type “SJSU” and then enter the semester and year you completed that course.
4. Plan — Select the “B)” (Non-Thesis) button.

[top]

3. Proposed Graduate Degree Program

Section 3.A Courses

When listing your courses, follow the format in the example below. List all of the iSchool courses that you have taken or that you plan on taking. Be sure to list semester units, grades received, and the semester it was or will be completed. List the courses in order taken, not numerically. For future classes, leave the Grade blank, but fill in the Semester Completed and Semester Units.

Proposed Graduate Degree Program

A. Courses (include all SJSU courses taken and those that will be taken for degree credit; leave Grade section blank for current and future classes.)

Course Prefix/No.	Title	Semester Units	Grade	Semester/Year Complete
MARA 200	Record and the Recordkeeping Professions	3	A	Fall 2014
MARA 204	Management of Records and Archival Institutions	3	A-	Fall 2014
MARA 210	Records Creation Appraisal and Retention	3	A	Spring 2015
LIBR 240	Information Technology Tools and Applications	3	B+	Spring 2015
MARA 211	Records Access, Storage and Retrieval	3	B+	Fall 2015
MARA 285	Research Methods in Records Management and Archives	3	A	Fall 2015
MARA 284	Seminar in Archives and Records Management - Topic Information Assurance	3	B+	Spring 2016
MARA 249	Electronic Recordkeeping Systems and Issues in Electronic Records Management	3	B+	Spring 2016
MARA 283	Enterprise Content Management and Digital Preservation	3	A	Fall 2016
MARA 284	Seminar in Archives and Records Management - Topic: Information Governance	3	A-	Fall 2016
INFO 246	Information Technology: Tools and Applications Advanced	3		Spring 2017
MARA 294	Professional Experience: Internship	3		Spring 2017
INFO 287	Seminar in Information Science (Cybersecurity)	3		Fall 2017

You must complete a total of 42 units for the MARA degree (3 of these units will be Culminating Experience units listed in section B). Do not list MARA 289 here. List it in Section B below. Do not list more than the required number of units needed for the program! If you have taken more than the required number of units, do not list more than the 42 units required. Be sure to list the required Core Classes. Visit this page for MARA required classes, based on admission date. **Note: Through Spring 2021 MARA 286 was taught as MARA 284 Information Assurance, and through Fall 2020 MARA 287 was taught as MARA 284 Information Governance.**

List your Culminating Experience course (MARA 289) in Section B below; do not list it here. List elective courses taken as “LIBR” through Summer 2015; then list them as “INFO” starting with Fall 2015. Up to 9 of the 12 units of electives can be INFO courses. The course grades listed on the candidacy form must result in an overall GPA of at least 3.0 (B). World Languages classes are to go in Section A. Students who carry an “Incomplete” grade will not be permitted to apply for candidacy. iSchool students may have no more than 15 units worth of Credit/No Credit coursework as part of their total 42 units for the MARA degree.

If you have taken LIBR or INFO courses, list them in section A along with the MARA courses, in the order taken.

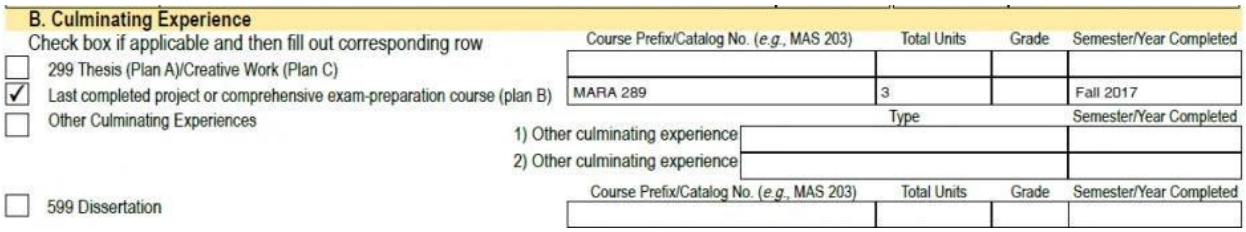
List only the classes that have a grade of C or higher. Do not list any classes with a grade of C- or below. If a student gets a C or better, it will count towards the degree. If a student gets a C- or lower, that class cannot be used on the Graduate Candidacy application or counted toward the degree. Instead, the student will have to take another class in substitution to get up to 42 units.

Use the titles on your transcript or MySJSU class list. You can also find course titles on the iSchool Course Descriptions list.

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Section 3.B Culminating Experience

In this section, list your planned MARA 289 course.



B. Culminating Experience

Check box if applicable and then fill out corresponding row

	Course Prefix/Catalog No. (*e.g.*, MAS 203)	Total Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
☐ 299 Thesis (Plan A)/Creative Work (Plan C)				
☑ Last completed project or comprehensive exam-preparation course (plan B)	MARA 289	3		Fall 2017
☐ Other Culminating Experiences				

	Type	Semester/Year Completed
1) Other culminating experience		
2) Other culminating experience		

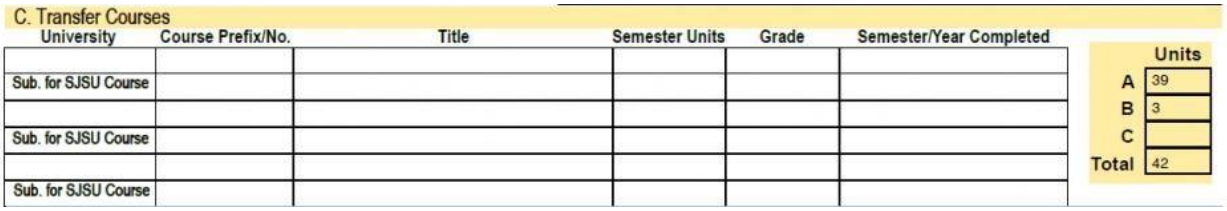
	Course Prefix/Catalog No. (*e.g.*, MAS 203)	Total Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
☐ 599 Dissertation				

Check the second box: Last completed project or comprehensive exam-preparation course (Plan B). Remember to type in “MARA” on the Course Prefix/Catalog No. line to the left and list the units and semester in the columns on the right, but do not list a grade. MARA 289 can only be taken in Spring or Fall.

[top]

Section 3.C Transfer Courses

In this section, list courses taken through other universities. Be sure to list grades received, semester units, and the semester it was or will be completed. Classes taken through iSchool Open Classes are to be listed in section C. (Open Classes courses do not need to be approved of as transfer credit. Just list them on section C). WISE classes are taken as INFO 298 and should be listed in section A on the Candidacy form. **Before doing this, please carefully read the information on the Transferring Units page**. The total units should not exceed 9 units. Note that iSchool will not approve any substitute for a required iSchool class. **Do not supply a "Substituted for" class. Leave those fields blank. Only list the information from the institution where you took the courses.**



C. Transfer Courses

University	Course Prefix/No.	Title	Semester Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
Sub. for SJSU Course					
Sub. for SJSU Course					
Sub. for SJSU Course					

	Units
A	39
B	3
C	
Total	42

Total Units — Fill in the number of units from Sections A, B, and C and the Total. You must complete 42 units for the MARA degree.

[top]

4. Required Signatures

Student Signature — Use Adobe Acrobat to provide a digital signature on the Student Signature line, or sign it electronically (if you have an electronic signature using another program). Click here for help with how to sign a PDF. Leave all other signatures blank. The iSchool office will review it, obtain the necessary signatures, and submit your form to GAPE.



An example digital signature of fake student "Chelsea Smith"



[top]

5. List of steps to submit the Candidacy Approval Form.

1. Proofread carefully to be sure you have correctly completed all the requested information.
2. Save to your own computer/desktop; save file as [YOURLASTNAME_YOURFIRSTNAME_STUDENTIDNUMBER].pdf.
3. Upload your Candidacy Form to the iSchool Candidacy form. Use your SJSU.Edu email address to login to the form.

- iSchool staff will review it, obtain signatures, and deliver it to the GAPE office.

[top]

6. Tracking your Candidacy and Making Changes to your Approved Plan

Important

GAPE takes at least a couple of months to properly evaluate your candidacy petition. You will know when if your candidacy has been approved in two ways: you will see it under “Other Indicators,” on MySJSU and you will receive a hard copy in the mail. Make sure MySJSU has your correct and current e-mail and mailing addresses. The School of Information has no information as to the status of your candidacy application; please do not contact the iSchool for this information. Note: Students who submit their Candidacy plan earlier than 6 months prior to the iSchool submission dates may have a longer wait for their form to be approved at SJSU GAPE, due to how the GAPE office prioritizes processing forms.

1. If you make any changes in actual course titles after your Candidacy form has been approved, you will need to submit a course substitution form to the Advising site on Canvas. Submit course substitution forms as soon as you have made changes to your course plan so that your graduation file is current when GAPE evaluates your Candidacy in the weeks immediately following your final semester. Failure to submit a course substitution form will delay your graduation. Watch your service indicators for messaging from GAPE in the weeks following your final semester.

2. If you change the date you plan to graduate after you have submitted an Application for Award of Master’s Degree form, you must submit a Change of Graduation Date Form and pay the $10.00 fee online.

Completing the MLIS Candidacy Approval Form

Note: The SJSU Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy form has changed. Please be sure you are using the most current form, available from this location.

Quick Links

1. Student Information
2. Degree Information
3. Proposed Graduate Degree Program
    - (Section A) Courses (excluding transfer courses)
    - (Section B) Culminating experience
    - (Section C) Transfer Courses
4. Required Signatures
5. How to Submit Your Candidacy Form
6. Tracking your Candidacy and Making Changes to your Approved Plan

This page contains instructions for MLIS candidacy applicants. Instructions for MARA candidacy applicants can be found on the page, Completing the MARA Candidacy Approval Form. **Note: Your form will not be approved for candidacy if your CUM GPA is below 3.0. You must have 9 units of graded classes on your transcript before you may file a Candidacy form.**

Candidacy Approval Form. The requirements for completing this form are fairly strict. Following the instructions below will help you successfully complete the form and avoid the delays and problems associated with needing to resubmit it. You can view a sample completed form.

You will need the latest version of Adobe Acrobat Reader DC (free to download). **Be sure to:**

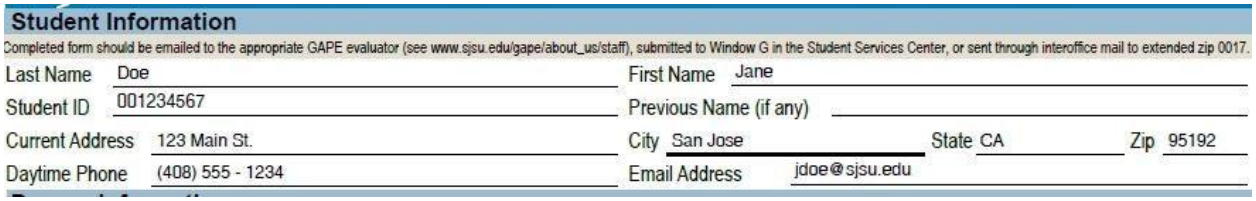
- Save the candidacy form onto your computer -do **not** try to fill it in online -Adobe Reader will give you an error message if you try to use it to sign an online PDF
- Be sure to use Adobe Reader DC

You can also download the Adobe Creative Cloud Software (including Adobe Acrobat) that is free to students -but with restrictions and limitations based on semester enrollment.

1. OPEN the Candidacy Approval form [PDF].
2. Do a **FILE/SAVE** AS to your computer, renaming the file as follows: [YOURLASTNAME_YOURFIRSTNAME_STUDENTIDNUMBER].pdf.
3. Open this file **from your computer** and, using Adobe Reader, TYPE directly into the form you see displayed on your computer screen.
4. SAVE to your **computer desktop.**
5. Upload the completed form to Canvas -see Steps to Submit the Candidacy Approval Form (below)

1. Student Information

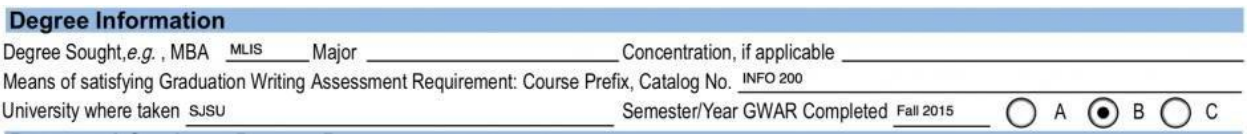
Disregard the statement at the top of the form: “This completed form should be emailed to the appropriate GAPE evaluator, submitted to Window G in the Student Services Center, or sent through interoffice mail to extended zip 0017,” as you will be submitting the form to iSchool who will then gather necessary signatures and forward the form to GAPE directly on your behalf.



1. Last Name/First Name, etc. — Click in the area marked “Last Name” and type in your last name. Complete the rest of this section by moving to each field and clicking in the area where you wish to type.
2. Student ID: Enter your MySJSU ID
3. Current Address, City, State and Zip: Enter your most up to date information in these fields.
4. Daytime Phone/ Email Address: Include your most recent telephone number and email address.

[top]

2. Degree Information



1. Degree Sought, e.g., MBA; Type in “MLIS”.
2. Leave the Major and Concentration fields blank.
3. Means of satisfying **GWAR** Graduate Writing Assessment Requirement: type in “LIBR 200 or INFO 200.” For University: type “SJSU” and then enter the semester and year you completed that course.
4. Plan — iSchool students taking the INFO 289 e-Portfolio course should choose “B)” (Non-Thesis) button. If you are writing a thesis to satisfy the culminating requirement, choose “A)” the 299 thesis option.

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3. Proposed Graduate Degree Program

Section 3.A Courses

When listing your courses, follow the format in the example below. List all of the iSchool courses that you have taken or that you plan on taking. Be sure to list semester units, grades received, and the semester it was or will be completed. List the courses in order taken, not numerically. For future classes, leave the Grade blank, but fill in the Semester Completed and Semester Units.

Proposed Graduate Degree Program

A. Courses (include all SJSU courses taken and those that will be taken for degree credit; leave Grade section blank for current and future classes.)

Course Prefix/No.	Title	Semester Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
INFO 203	Online Learning: Tools and Strategies for Success	1	CR	Fall 2015
INFO 200	Information Communities	3	A	Fall 2015
INFO 202	Information Retrieval System Design	3	A	Spring 2016
INFO 204	Information Professions	3	A	Spring 2016
INFO 257	Records Management	3	A	Summer 2016
INFO 240	Information Technology Tools and Applications	3	A	Fall 2016
INFO 244	Online Searching	3	A-	Fall 2016
INFO 246	Information Technology Tools and Applications - Advanced	3	A	Spring 2017
INFO 251	Web Usability	3	A	Spring 2017
INFO 248	Beginning Cataloging and Classification	3	A	Summer 2017
INFO 250	Design and Implementation of Instructional Strategies for Information Professionals	3	A	Summer 2017
INFO 285	Research Methods	3		Fall 2017
INFO 298	Special Studies	3		Fall 2017
INFO 242	Database Management	3		Spring 2018

You must complete 43 units for the MLIS degree (3 of these units will be Culminating Experience units listed in section B). **Do not list more than the required number of units needed for the program!** If you have taken more than the required number of units, do not list more than the 43 units required. Be sure to list the required classes of 200, 202, 203, 204, and 285. List your Culminating Experience course (INFO 289 or INFO 299) in Section B below; do not list it here. List courses taken as LIBR through Summer 2015; then list them as INFO starting with Fall 2015. List any MARA or INFM

courses taken as electives here as well. The course grades listed on the candidacy form must result in an overall GPA of at least 3.0 (B). Students who carry an “Incomplete” grade will not be permitted to apply for candidacy. World Languages classes are to go in Section A. iSchool students may have no more than 15 units worth of Credit/No Credit coursework as part of their total 43 units for the MLIS degree.

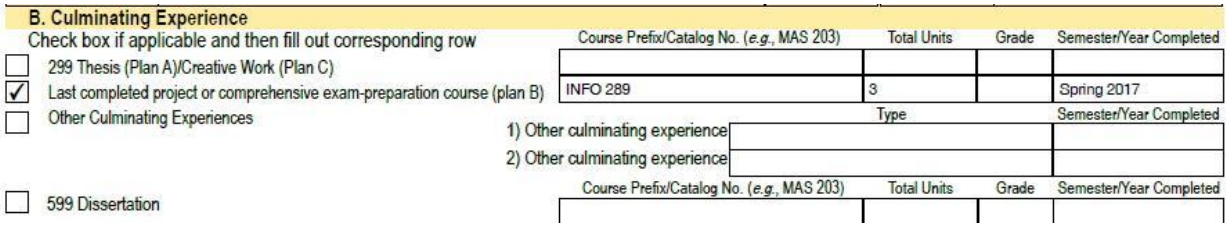
List only the classes that have a grade of C or higher. Do not list any classes with a grade of C- or below. If a student gets a C or better, it will count towards the degree. If a student gets a C- or lower, that class cannot be used on the Graduate Candidacy application or counted toward the degree. Instead, the student will have to take another class in substitution to get up to 42 or 43 units.

Use the titles on your transcript or MySJSU class list. You can also find course titles on the iSchool Course Descriptions list.

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Section 3.B Culminating Experience

In this section, list how you intend on fulfilling the culminating requirement. This can be either INFO 299 Thesis or INFO 289.



B. Culminating Experience

Check box if applicable and then fill out corresponding row

	Course Prefix/Catalog No. (*e.g.*, MAS 203)	Total Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
☐ 299 Thesis (Plan A)/Creative Work (Plan C)				
☑ Last completed project or comprehensive exam-preparation course (plan B)	INFO 289	3		Spring 2017
☐ Other Culminating Experiences				

	Type	Semester/Year Completed
1) Other culminating experience		
2) Other culminating experience		

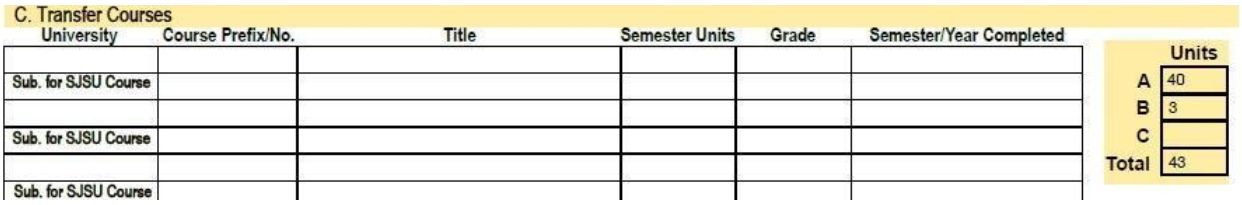
☐ 599 Dissertation	Course Prefix/Catalog No. (*e.g.*, MAS 203)	Total Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed

If you plan to complete the e-Portfolio option to satisfy the University’s graduation requirement, check the second box Last completed project or comprehensive exam-preparation course (Plan B). If you plan to do a Thesis, check the “299 Thesis (Plan A)/ Creative Work (Plan C)” box and indicate the units you plan to do for your Thesis and the semester in which you plan to complete the Thesis. Remember to type in “INFO” on the Course Prefix/Catalog No. line to the left and list the units and semester in the columns on the right, but do not list a grade. INFO 289 and 299 are not offered in the Summer. They can only be taken in Spring or Fall. Your culminating experience class counts toward your final 43 units.

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Section 3.C Transfer Courses

In this section, list any courses that you wish to transfer from other schools. Be sure to list grades received, semester units, and the semester it was or will be completed. Classes taken through iSchool Open Classes are to be listed in section C. (Open Classes courses do not need to be approved of as transfer credit. Just list them on section C). WISE classes are taken as INFO 298 and should be listed in section A on the Candidacy form. **Before doing this, please carefully read the information on the Transferring Units page**. The total units should not exceed 9 units. Note that iSchool will not approve any substitute for a required iSchool class. **Do not supply a "Substituted for" class. Leave those fields blank. Only list the information from the institution where you took the courses.**



C. Transfer Courses

University	Course Prefix/No.	Title	Semester Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
Sub. for SJSU Course					
Sub. for SJSU Course					
Sub. for SJSU Course					

	Units
A	40
B	3
C	
Total	43

Total Units — Fill in the number of units from Sections A, B, and C and the Total. You must complete 43 units for the MLIS degree.

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4. Required Signatures

Student Signature — Use Adobe Acrobat to provide a digital signature on the Student Signature line, or sign it electronically (if you have an electronic signature using another program). Click here for help with how to sign a PDF. Leave all other signatures blank. The iSchool office will review it, obtain the necessary signatures, and submit your form to GAPE.



Example Signature for fake student "Chelsea Smith"



[top]

5. Steps to submit the Candidacy Approval Form.

1. Proofread carefully to be sure you have correctly completed all the requested information.
2. Save to your own computer/desktop; save file as [YOURLASTNAME_YOURFIRSTNAME_STUDENTIDNUMBER].pdf.
3. Upload your Candidacy Form to the iSchool Candidacy form. You will need to use your SJSU.edu email to login to the form.

- iSchool staff will review it, obtain signatures, and deliver it to the GAPE office.

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6. Tracking your Candidacy and Making Changes to your Approved Plan

Important

GAPE takes at least a couple of months to properly evaluate your candidacy petition. You will know when if your candidacy has been approved in two ways: you will see it under “Other Indicators,” on MySJSU and you will receive an email. Make sure MySJSU has your correct and current e-mail and mailing addresses. The School of Information has no information as to the status of your candidacy application; please do not contact the iSchool for this information. Note: Students who submit their Candidacy plan earlier than 6 months prior to the iSchool submission dates may have a longer wait for their form to be approved at SJSU GAPE, due to how the GAPE office prioritizes processing forms.

1. If you make any changes in actual course titles after your Candidacy form has been approved, you will need to submit a course substitution form to the Advising site on Canvas. Submit course substitution forms as soon as you have made changes to your course plan so that your graduation file is current when GAPE evaluates your Candidacy in the weeks immediately following your final semester. Failure to submit a course substitution form will delay your graduation. Watch your service indicators for messaging from GAPE in the weeks following your final semester.

2. If you change the date you plan to graduate after you have submitted an Application for Award of Master’s Degree form, you must submit a Change of Graduation Date Form and pay the $10.00 fee online.

Completing the MS in Informatics Candidacy Approval Form

Note: The SJSU Petition for Advancement to Graduate Candidacy form has changed. Please be sure you are using the most current form, available from this location.

Quick Links

1. Student Information
2. Degree Information
3. Proposed Graduate Degree Program
    - (Section A) Courses (excluding transfer courses)
    - (Section B) Culminating experience
    - (Section C) Transfer Courses
4. Required Signatures
5. How to Submit Your Candidacy Form
6. Tracking your Candidacy and Making Changes to your Approved Plan

This page contains instructions for MS in Informatics candidacy applicants. **Note: Your form will not be approved for candidacy if your CUM GPA is below 3.0. You must have 9 units of graded classes on your transcript before you may file a Candidacy form.**

Candidacy Approval Form. The requirements for completing this form are fairly strict. Following the instructions below will help you successfully complete the form and avoid the delays and problems associated with needing to resubmit it. You can view a sample completed form.

You will need the latest version of Adobe Acrobat Reader DC (free to download). **Be sure to:**

- Save the candidacy form onto your computer -do not try to fill it in online -Adobe Reader will give you an error message if you try to use it to sign an online PDF
- Be sure to use Adobe Reader DC

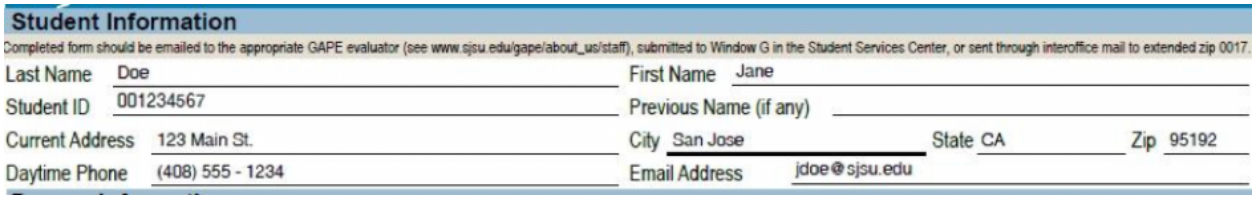
You can also download the Adobe Creative Cloud Software (including Adobe Acrobat) that is free to students -but with restrictions and limitations based on semester enrollment.

1. OPEN the Candidacy Approval Form [PDF].

2. Do a **FILE/SAVE** AS to your computer, renaming the file as follows: [YOURLASTNAME_YOURFIRSTNAME_STUDENTIDNUMBER].pdf.
3. Open this file **from your computer** and, using Adobe Reader, TYPE directly into the form you see displayed on your computer screen.
4. SAVE to your **computer desktop**.
5. Upload the completed form to Canvas -see Steps to Submit the Candidacy Approval Form (below)

1. Student Information

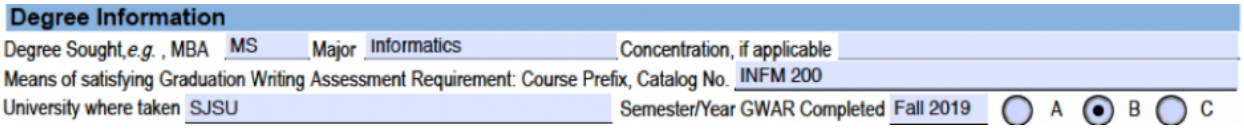
Disregard the statement at the top of the form: “This completed form should be emailed to the appropriate GAPE evaluator, submitted to Window G in the Student Services Center, or sent through interoffice mail to extended zip 0017,” as you will be submitting the form to iSchool who will then gather necessary signatures and forward the form to GAPE directly on your behalf.



1. Last Name/First Name, etc. — Click in the area marked “Last Name” and type in your last name. Complete the rest of this section by moving to each field and clicking in the area where you wish to type.
2. Student ID: Enter your MySJSU ID
3. Current Address, City, State and Zip: Enter your most up to date information in these fields.
4. Daytime Phone/ Email Address: Include your most recent telephone number and email address.

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2. Degree Information



1. Degree Sought, e.g., MBA; Type in “MS”.

2. Enter “Informatics” for Major and leave Concentration field blank.
3. Means of satisfying **GWAR** Graduate Writing Assessment Requirement: type in “INFM 200.” For University: type “SJSU” and then enter the semester and year you completed that course.
4. Plan — iSchool students will choose “B)” (Non-Thesis) button.

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3. Proposed Graduate Degree Program

Section 3.A Courses

When listing your courses, follow the format in the example below. List all of the iSchool courses that you have taken or that you plan on taking. Be sure to list semester units, grades received, and the semester it was or will be completed. List the courses in order taken, not numerically. For future classes, leave the Grade blank, but fill in the Semester Completed and Semester Units.

Proposed Graduate Degree Program

A. Courses (include all SJSU courses taken and those that will be taken for degree credit; leave Grade section blank for current and future classes.)

Course Prefix/No.	Title	Semester Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
INFM 200	Informatics: Fundamentals	3	A	Fall 2019
INFM 201	Informatics: Technology Foundations	2	A	Fall 2019
INFM 202	Information Security: Overview	1	A	Fall 2019
INFM 203	Big Data Analytics and Management	2	B+	Fall 2019
INFM 204	Human Centered Design	2	A	Fall 2019
INFM 205	Informatics: Project Management	2	B	Fall 2019
INFM 206	Electronic Records: Foundations	3		Spring 2020
INFM 207	DAM: Digital Assets Management	2		Spring 2020
INFM 208	Information Security: Information Assurance	1		Spring 2020
INFM 210	Health Informatics	3		Spring 2020
INFM 213	Epidemiological Methods	3		Spring 2020
INFM 214	Health Data and Analytics	3		Summer 2020

You must complete 30 units for the MS in Informatics degree (3 of these units will be INFM 211, your Capstone course listed in section B). **Do not list more than the required number of units needed for the program!** If you have taken more than the required number of units, do not list more than the 30 units required. List your Capstone course (INFM 211) in Section B below; do not list it here. The course grades listed on the candidacy form must result in an overall GPA of at least 3.0 (B). Students who carry an “Incomplete” grade will not be permitted to apply for candidacy.

List only the classes that have a grade of C or higher. Do not list any classes with a grade of C- or below. If a student gets a C or better, it will count towards the degree. If a student gets a C- or lower, that class cannot be used on the Graduate Candidacy

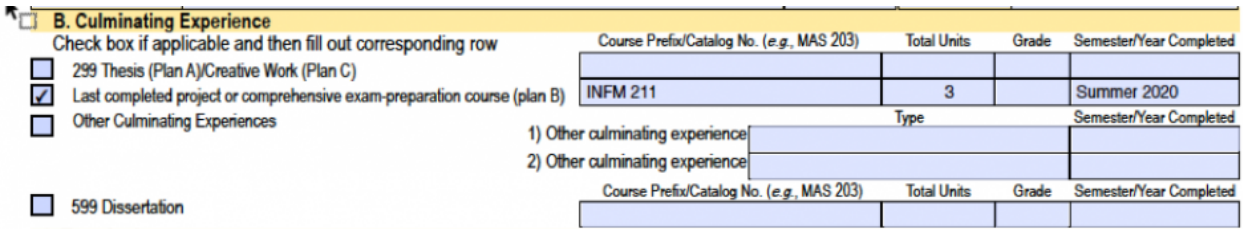
application or counted toward the degree. Instead, the student will have to take another class in substitution to get up to 30 units.

Use the titles on your transcript or MySJSU class list. You can also find course titles on the Informatics Course Descriptions and Specializations list.

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Section 3.B Culminating Experience

In this section, you will check mark “Last completed project,” and enter “INFM” into the Course Prefix field. Enter “3” into the Total Units field and enter the Semester/Year you plan to complete the course.



B. Culminating Experience

Check box if applicable and then fill out corresponding row

	Course Prefix/Catalog No. (*e.g.*, MAS 203)	Total Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
☐ 299 Thesis (Plan A)/Creative Work (Plan C)				
☑ Last completed project or comprehensive exam-preparation course (plan B)	INFM 211	3		Summer 2020
☐ Other Culminating Experiences				

	Type	Semester/Year Completed
1) Other culminating experience		
2) Other culminating experience		

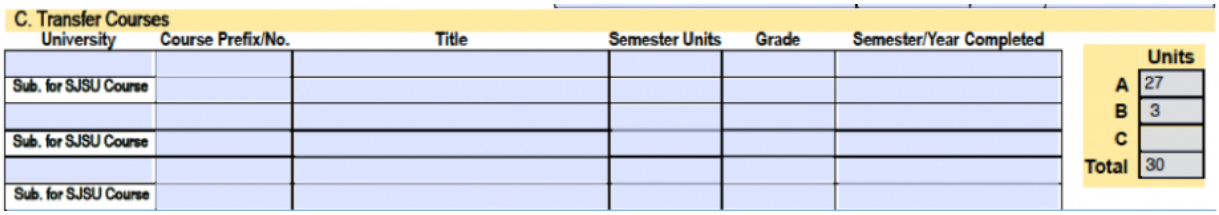
	Course Prefix/Catalog No. (*e.g.*, MAS 203)	Total Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
☐ 599 Dissertation				

Do not list a grade. Your culminating experience class does count toward your final 30 units.

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Section 3.C Transfer Courses

Leave this section blank, unless you took any INFM courses through iSchool Open Classes. List any INFM classes taken through iSchool Open Classes in this section of the Form.



C. Transfer Courses

University	Course Prefix/No.	Title	Semester Units	Grade	Semester/Year Completed
Sub. for SJSU Course					
Sub. for SJSU Course					
Sub. for SJSU Course					

	Units
A	27
B	3
C	
Total	30

Total Units — Fill in the number of units from Sections A, B, and C and the Total. You must complete 30 units for the MS Informatics degree.

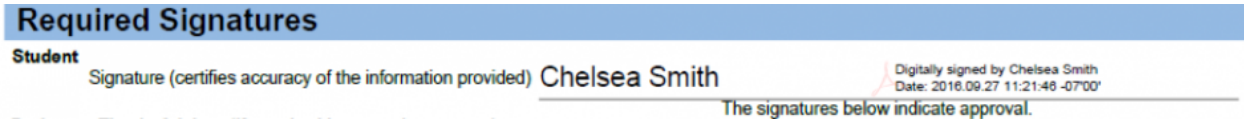
[top]

4. Required Signatures

Student Signature — Use Adobe Acrobat to provide a digital signature on the Student Signature line, or sign it electronically (if you have an electronic signature using another program). Click here for help with how to sign a PDF. Leave all other signatures blank. The iSchool office will review it, obtain the necessary signatures, and submit your form to GAPE.



Example Signature for fake student "Chelsea Smith"



[top]

5. Steps to submit the Candidacy Approval Form.

1. Proofread carefully to be sure you have correctly completed all the requested information.
2. Save to your own computer/desktop; save file as [YOURLASTNAME_YOURFIRSTNAME_STUDENTIDNUMBER].pdf.
3. Make sure to upload your Candidacy Form to the iSchool Candidacy form. You will need to use your SJSU.edu email to login to the form.

- iSchool staff will review it, obtain signatures, and deliver it to the GAPE office.

[top]

6. Tracking your Candidacy and Making Changes to your Approved Plan

Important

GAPE takes at least a couple of months to properly evaluate your candidacy petition. You will know when if your candidacy has been approved in two ways: you will see it under "Other Indicators," on MySJSU and you will receive a hard copy in the mail. Make

sure MySJSU has your correct and current e-mail and mailing addresses. The School of Information has no information as to the status of your candidacy application; please do not contact the iSchool for this information. Note: Students who submit their Candidacy plan earlier than 6 months prior to the iSchool submission dates may have a longer wait for their form to be approved at SJSU GAPE, due to how the GAPE office prioritizes processing forms.

1. If you make any changes in actual course titles after your Candidacy form has been approved, you will need to submit a course substitution form to the Advising site on Canvas. Submit course substitution forms as soon as you have made changes to your course plan so that your graduation file is current when GAPE evaluates your Candidacy in the weeks immediately following your final semester. Failure to submit a course substitution form will delay your graduation. Watch your service indicators for messaging from GAPE in the weeks following your final semester.

2. If you change the date you plan to graduate after you have submitted an Application for Award of Master's Degree form, you must submit a Change of Graduation Date Form and pay the $10.00 fee online.

Application for Award of Graduate Degree Online Process

Must be completed online by the posted deadline **Paper forms are no longer accepted by GAPE**

- Due date for May graduation: February 1
- Due date for August graduation: March 1
- Due date for December graduation: September 1

You must apply to graduate with GAPE for graduation after your candidacy has been approved.

First-time Applicants:

Eligible students can apply for graduation through self-service within their MySJSU account. Approximately two weeks after students have been approved for advancement to candidacy by the GAPE office, they will be sent a MySJSU message prompting them to apply for graduation.

Steps to Apply: Go to your MySJSU Account.

1. Click on **MyAcademics** in your Student Center > 2. Click on **Apply for Graduation** on MyAcademics page > 3. Click on **Apply for Graduation** on the Submit an Application for Graduation page > 4. **Select the Term** you plan to graduate from the drop-down menu for the Expected Graduation Term. (Example: Select “May 2024″ for Spring graduation). Then Click “**Continue**.” > 5. Click “**Submit Application**” on the Verify Graduation Data page. Once you click submit you have officially applied to graduate.

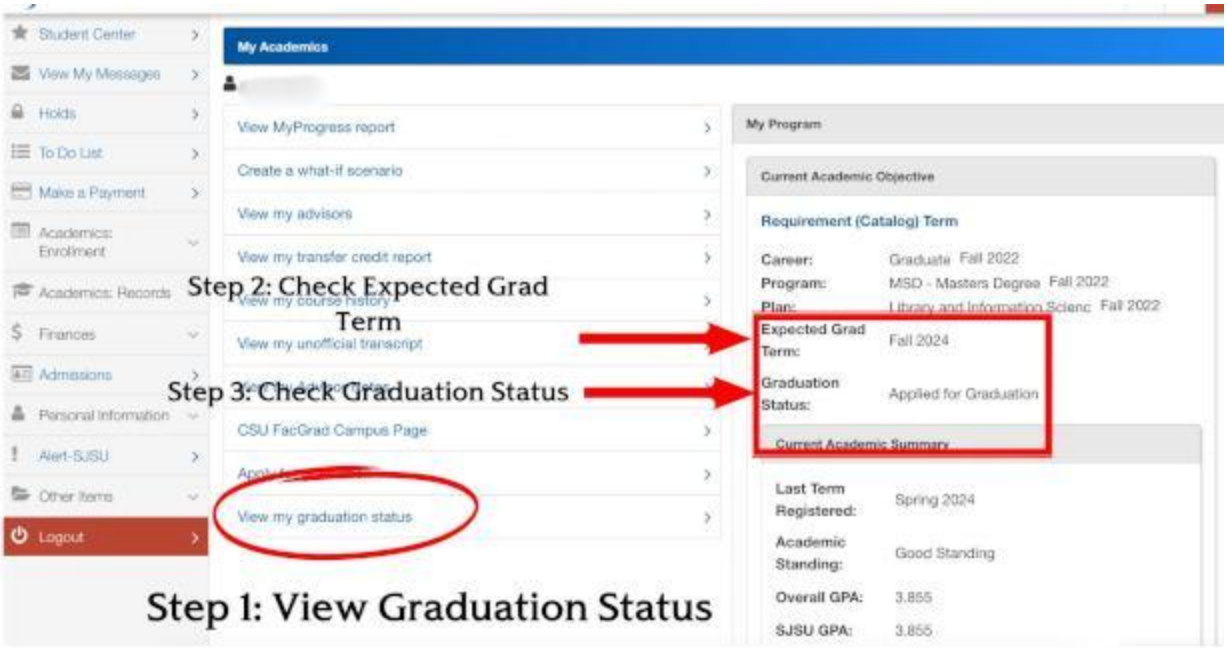
Make sure to update your Mailing Address to ensure you receive your diploma at the correct address.

GAPE runs the MySJSU query to activate your MySJSU graduation link only every two weeks. If you have received the prompt to complete this process, but do not have the link yet, know that it should appear within two weeks, and your application will be accepted late. Please contact GAPE if you have follow-up questions.

MS Informatics Students: Typically GAPE will not issue the link to apply for graduation until you have 15 units of graded classes. If you have not received a link to apply for graduation two weeks after the service indicator showing your Candidacy is approved has appeared in your MySJSU account, contact GAPE for instructions on when and how to apply for graduation with their office.

Once you have applied you can check your application status in your account.

Check your Application Status in your MySJSU Account by Following these steps:
Student Center > My Academics > View My Graduation Status > Current Academic Objective > Expected Grad Term and Graduation Status to see your Expected Graduation Term and Graduation Status.



Important: If you have previously applied for graduation and need to change your graduation date, see these instructions.

Awards for Excellence for Graduating Students

The Ken Haycock Award for Exceptional Professional Promise

Open for applications February 1 – February 28

The Ken Haycock Award is given annually to the MLIS student who, in the opinion of the faculty, exhibits the most exceptional professional promise for leadership. The recipient demonstrates flexibility in program delivery modes, excellence in academic performance, ability to think theoretically and practically and ability to analyze and communicate the results of knowledge gained. The award winner will be honored by being the Outstanding Student speaker at convocation, and will also receive $1,000 and a citation.

The Ken Haycock Award opens for nominations on February 1 (before the other award nominations) because the winner becomes the Outstanding Student speaker at the iSchool convocation.

To self-nominate or to be nominated for the Haycock Award, submit the iSchool Awards form between February 1 and the February 28 deadline to the Ken Haycock Award drop box in the advising site on Canvas. August and December Graduates: If you no longer have access to the advising site in Canvas, email your completed form to Roffna Principe.

Eligible students graduated last December, as well as those who will be graduating this May or August. A final decision will be made by the members of the Student Scholarships and Awards Committee. The award recipient will be notified during the third week of March.

Awards for Graduating Students

Open for applications March 1 – March 30

To self-nominate or to nominate another graduating student for all other awards, submit the iSchool Awards form by the March 30 deadline. Eligible students are those who graduated in the previous December, as well as those who will be graduating this May or August. Final decisions are made by the faculty members of the Student Scholarships and Awards Committee. Award recipients are notified beginning the third Monday in April.

Award for Outstanding Thesis

Awarded annually to the student who, in the opinion of the faculty, completed the most outstanding graduate thesis in library and information science. The recipient must have demonstrated superior academic performance in research methods, thesis design and writing.

The award consists of a gift certificate and citation.

Director's Award for Excellence in Diversity and Inclusion

Awarded annually to the student who, in the opinion of the faculty, has shown outstanding leadership through a work or community service innovation, internship or scholarly research effort benefiting an economically, linguistically or otherwise diverse service population.

The award consists of a gift certificate and citation.

Director's Award for Excellence in Intellectual Inquiry

Awarded annually to the student who, in the opinion of the faculty, has demonstrated intellectual curiosity above and beyond their required coursework, a passion for learning, and continued learning.

The award consists of a gift certificate and citation.

Director's Award for Excellence in International Contribution

Awarded annually to the student who, in the opinion of the faculty, has demonstrated outstanding involvement in library and information science on a global scale.

The award consists of a gift certificate and citation.

Director's Award for Excellence in Innovation

Awarded annually to the student who, in the opinion of the faculty, has demonstrated a strong ability to develop and implement novel approaches to services and the use of technology.

The award consists of a gift certificate and citation.

Director's Award for Excellence in Building Community

Awarded annually to the student who, in the opinion of the faculty, has demonstrated an ability to work collaboratively and strengthen communities of all types.

The award consists of a gift certificate and citation.

Applying for School of Information Awards

Please submit your **iSchool Award Application** via Canvas. Do Not FAX to the iSchool — FAXes will not be accepted.

DEADLINE: February 28 for the Haycock Award and March 30 for all other awards (11:59 PM PT)

How to Fill Out and Submit the iSchool Award Application

Follow the instructions below to successfully complete and submit your application to nominate yourself or someone else for the iSchool Graduating Student Awards.

Read more

Graduating Student Award Recipients

The iSchool honors graduating students annually through awards for excellence in a variety of categories.

Ken Haycock Award for Exceptional Professional Promise

Read more

Onsite Graduation Ceremony Spring 2026

Congratulations!

The SJSU School of Information students participate in the onsite university commencement ceremony held **by the college twice a year (in fall for fall graduates and in spring for spring and summer graduates)**. Graduates from fall, spring and summer will receive information from SJSU Commencement inviting them to participate in university-wide celebration events for all university graduates.

> The university's plans are in addition to our iSchool departmental online event, which only focuses on MLIS, MARA, Informatics graduates.

The School of Information's Virtual Graduation Zoom Celebration, iSchool Graduation Video, and Virtual Graduation Website Platform are all separate from, and in addition to, activities planned by the SJSU Commencement Office for university-wide graduates.

The College of Information, Data and Society Spring 2026 Commencement will be held on Thur. May 21, 2026 at 7pm Pacific.

Graduation Eligibility

If Spring or Summer is your last semester, and you intend to graduate in May or August, you will only be eligible to participate in May commencement if the following requirements have been met:

1. You have been advanced to graduate candidacy (an approved candidacy form is on file with GAPE).
2. You have submitted an Application for Award of Master's Degree for May or August graduation (this is not the same as the candidacy form).
3. You have completed INFO 289 e-Portfolio or INFO 299 Thesis, or MARA 289 or INFM 211.

Please contact the SJSU iSchool Student Services Team with any questions about the graduation application process, qualifications, and/or eligibility. The Graduation Checklist and Graduation Process Video are helpful resources.

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2023 CPGE Commencement Livestreams

For the on-site **2023 CPGE Commencement**, we will be live-streaming three events: the Office Tour, Reception, and Graduation Ceremony. You will be able to see the first-hand perspective and experience of a graduating student using a mixed-reality HoloLens2 headset. Experience what she is experiencing in real time. Experience graduation day at San Jose State through her eyes!

Read more

Virtual Graduation Celebration

iSchool graduates can choose to participate in any or all of the three virtual opportunities iSchool provides to honor graduates: 1. Virtual Graduation Zoom Celebration, 2. Graduate Video, 3. Virtual Graduation Website.

For information about the onsite ceremony, see the onsite graduation page of our website.

1. Virtual Graduation Zoom Celebration

iSchool program leaders; the invited convocation speaker; the College Dean; and the graduating student speaker will deliver remarks.

Graduate names are not read aloud at the virtual graduation celebration; however, a graduate video featuring student-submitted photos is shown at the end of the virtual ceremony (see 2 below).

Click here to view the graduation video from May 2025.

When: Friday, May 15, 2026 starting at 5pm – 6:30pm Pacific.

How to Participate: Graduates will be sent instructions on how to access the online event held twice a year, in May and in December.

Questions: Contact iSchool Student Services

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2. Graduate Video

Each year, iSchool creates a special video featuring the graduates from that academic year. Participation is optional. The video culminates the virtual graduation celebration. View the video from Fall 2025.

How to Participate: Graduating students can submit a profile to be included in the Graduate Video. Deadline to submit a profile for the video is: May 1, 2026.

Questions: iSchool Student Services

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3. Virtual Graduation Website

A special online graduation platform celebrates our graduates and includes messages from our speakers, graduate profiles, graduating student award winners, and a degree presentation. Participation is optional.

Everyone is welcomed to post congratulatory messages on the graduate profile pages. Graduates can be found via degree or a name search. Please share your words of wisdom and let our graduates know how proud you are of their accomplishments!

How to Participate: Students completing their degree in the 2025-26 academic year can create and submit a graduate profile.

Important: Be sure to click "**Submit**" once you have saved your profile. A confirmation message will be received once a profile has been submitted to the system. If you "Save" but do not "Submit," the profile will not be registered.

For graduates with an identified disability (such as a visual or hearing impairment), if you require assistance with the graduate profile registration process, please contact iSchool IT staff member TC Truong for assistance.

Questions: For troubleshooting your profile submission, contact iSchool Tech Support.